

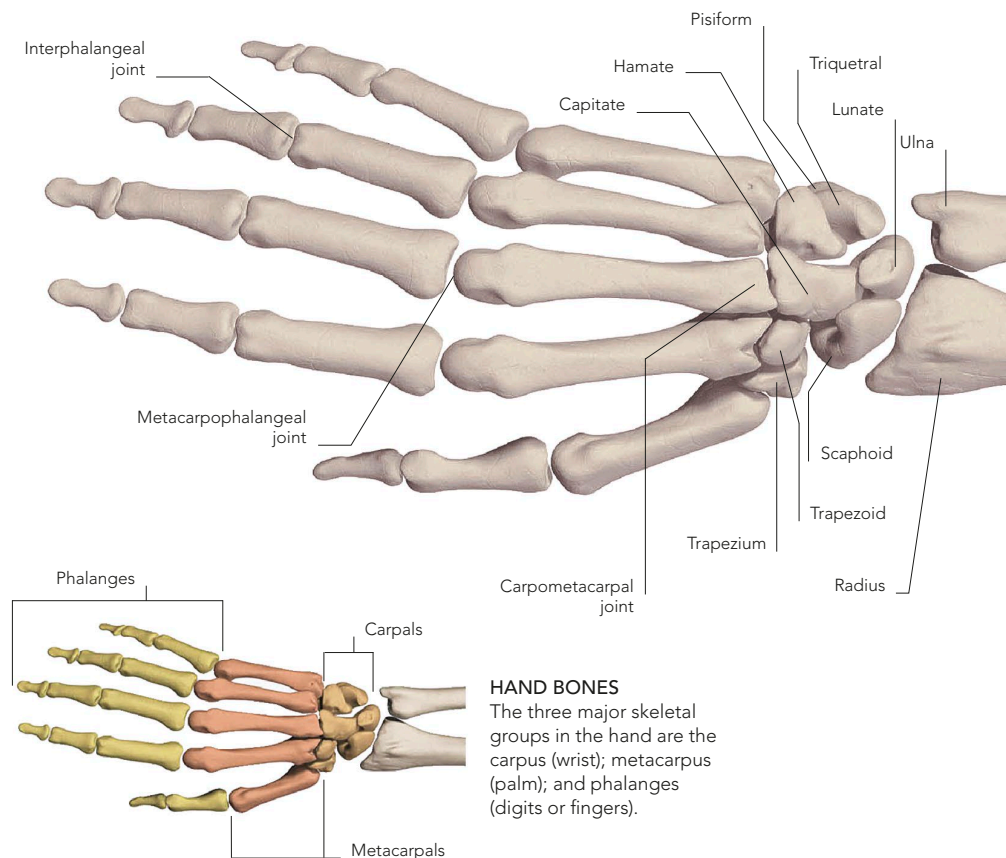
HANDS AND FEET

THE WRISTS, HANDS, ANKLES, AND FEET COLLECTIVELY CONTAIN 106 BONES, WHICH IS MORE THAN HALF OF ALL THE 206 BONES IN THE BODY. TOGETHER WITH THEIR ASSOCIATED MUSCLES, THEY ARE VITAL FOR COORDINATED MOVEMENT.

WRIST AND HAND

The wrist is made up of the eight carpal bones, arranged roughly in two rows of four. They are linked to each other chiefly by plane or gliding joints (see p.44), and to the forearm bones by the radiocarpal joint. The palm of the hand contains five metacarpal bones. Each of these joins at

its outer end to a finger bone (phalanx), of which there are two in the thumb (first digit, or pollex) and three each in the other four digits. The entire structure is moved by more than 50 muscles, including some in the forearm, to provide great flexibility and delicate manipulation.



HAND BONES

The three major skeletal groups in the hand are the carpus (wrist); metacarpus (palm); and phalanges (digits or fingers).